



10 EASY Chinese Idioms (成语) to Sound Like a Fluent Speaker

1. 一模一样 (yì mú yí yàng)

一模一样(yì mú yí yàng) means as like as two peas or be exactly alike. It is used to describe something that is exactly the same and not different at all.

Examples:

你的衣服和我的衣服**一模一样**。
Nǐ de yī fu hé wǒ de yī fu yì mú yí yàng.
Your dress is exactly the same as mine.

他和他爸爸长得**一模一样**。
Tā hé tā bà ba zhǎng de yì mú yí yàng.
He looks exactly like his dad.

2. 乱七八糟 (luàn qī bā zāo)

乱七八糟(luàn qī bā zāo) is a negative Chinese chengyu meaning be out of order, messy and not neat at all. It can be used to describe specific things or people's psychological feelings.

Examples:

你的作业写得**乱七八糟**，很多字都看不清楚。
Nǐ de zuò yè xiě de luàn qī bā zāo, hěn duō zì dōu kàn bù qīng chǔ.
Your homework is so messy and I cannot make out a lot of the characters.

我心里**乱七八糟**的。
Wǒ zhè xīn lǐ luàn qī bā zāo de.
I'm in a mess.

3. 莫名其妙 (mò míng qí miào)

Here we take apart this idiom to explain the meaning of the four words. “莫(mò)” is an adverb indicating there is no one or nothing. “名(míng)” means tell or describe in written Chinese. “其(qí)” is a pronoun which denotes his, her, or its. “妙(miào)” is secret. So the whole chengyu means no one can tell what's the secret. When you think something is strange and confusing, you can say it is “莫名其妙(mò míng qí miào)”.

Examples:

最近我常常**莫名其妙**地头疼。
Zuì jìn wǒ cháng cháng huì mò míng qí miào de tóu téng.
I often have headaches lately for no reason.

明明是你的错，为什么要我道歉，**莫名其妙**。
Míng míng shì nǐ de cuò, wèi shén me yào wǒ dào qiàn, mò míng qí miào.
It is obviously your fault. Why are you asking me to apologize? So weird.

4. 一见钟情 (yí jiàn zhōng qíng)

How long does it take to fall in love with someone? People can fall in love when they met first. There is a Chinese idiom to describe this case, that is “一见钟情(yí jiàn zhōng qíng)”. It means fall in love at first sight.

Examples:

你相信**一见钟情**吗?
Nǐ xiāng xìn yí jiàn zhōng qíng ma?
Do you believe in love at first sight?

他在一次聚会上遇到了丽丽，两人**一见钟情**。
Tā zài yí cì jù huì shàng yù dào le Lì lì, liǎng rén yí jiàn zhōng qíng.
He met Lili at a party and they fell in love at first sight.

5. 胡思乱想 (hú sī luàn xiǎng)

胡思乱想(hú sī luàn xiǎng) means having unfounded and unrealistic thoughts, and these thoughts are usually of no use to us.

Examples:

她晚上睡不着，总躺在床上**胡思乱想**。
Tā wǎn shàng shuì bu zháo, zǒng táng zài chuáng shàng hú sī luàn xiǎng.
She can't sleep at night, often overthinking in bed.

别在那儿**胡思乱想**了，快过来帮我整理东西吧。
Bié zài nàr hú sī luàn xiǎng le, kuài guò lái bāng wǒ zhěng lǐ dōng xi ba.
Stop overthinking. Come help me organize.

6. 胡说八道 (hú shuō bā dào)

It is annoying when someone keeps talking nonsense. Do you know which chengyu can be used to describe such behavior? It is “胡说八道(hú shuō bā dào)”. This idiom refers to irresponsible nonsense (to talk rubbish).

Examples:

如果你不知道这件事，就不要**胡说八道**。
Rú guǒ nǐ bù zhī dào zhè jiàn shì, jiù bú yào hú shuō bā dào.
If you don't know what happened, don't make things up.

你这样不负责任地**胡说八道**，是在欺骗人家。
Nǐ zhè yàng bù fù zé rèn de hú shuō bā dào , shì zài qī piàn rén jiā.
You are lying to them by speaking nonsense irresponsibly.

7. 稀里糊涂 (xī li hú tú)

稀里糊涂(xī li hú tú) has two meanings, one of which indicates confused and the other refers to doing things carelessly.

Examples:

这道题他讲了两遍，我还是**稀里糊涂**的。
Zhè dào tí tā jiǎng le liǎng biàn, wǒ hái shì xī li hú tú de.
He has explained this question twice, but I am still confused.'

这件事没有经过认真讨论，就**稀里糊涂**地通过了。
Zhè jiàn shì méi yǒu jīng guò rèn zhēn tāo lùn, jiù xī li hú tú de tōng guò le.
This matter was never discussed thoroughly and it was muddled through.

8. 自由自在 (zì yóu zì zài)

This is an idiom that many people like and yearn for. 自由自在(zì yóu zì zài) means free, without any restrictions, comfortable and at ease. It can be used to describe people's character or behavior. It can also be used to describe the feeling of a place.

Examples:

我很怀念在大学**自由自在**的日子。
Wǒ hěn huái niàn zài dà xué zì yóu zì zài de rì zi.
I really miss my easy and free university days.

我想有一天能够**自由自在**地做我自己想做的事情。
Wǒ xiǎng yǒu yì tiān néng gòu zì yóu zì zài de zuò wǒ zì jǐ xiǎng zuò de shì qing.
I think one day I will be free to do anything I want.

9. 自以为是 (zì yǐ wéi shì)

People who are “自以为是(zì yǐ wéi shì)” always think they are right, whether it is what they do or their points of view, and never accept others' opinions.

Examples:

小明一直**自以为是**，觉得任何人都比不上他。
Xiǎo míng yì zhí zì yǐ wéi shì, jué de rén hé rén dōu bǐ bu shàng tā.
Xiaoming has always been very conceited, thinking he is superior to others.

她遇到问题不会去请教别人，只会**自以为是**地处理。
Tā yù dào wèn tí bú huì qù qǐng jiào bié rén, zhǐ huì zì yǐ wéi shì de chǔ lǐ.
She never asks for help and only deals with things the way she wants.

10. 十全十美 (shí quán shí měi)

十全十美(shí quán shí měi) is equivalent to perfect English, which indicates something or someone is without any flaws.

Examples:

每个人都有自己的缺点，不可能**十全十美**。
Měi ge rén dōu yǒu zì jǐ de quē diǎn, bù kě néng shí quán shí měi.
Everyone has their flaws and no one is perfect.

他做任何事情都希望**十全十美**。
Tā zuò rèn hé shì qing dōu xī wàng shí quán shí měi.
He expects everything to be perfect.